Explore Further / A. Scripture & Church teaching

Optional print companion. You can finish the 15-minute Daniel lesson without this library. Read an introduction, choose a question, and use printed scriptures to begin. Full external resources require later access to the web.

Scripture and authoritative Church teachings are the primary doctrinal sources. Academic work adds historical and literary context; it does not replace them.

November 9-15: "There Is No Other God That Can Deliver": Daniel 1-7

The Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-day Saints

Official lesson / Come, Follow Me - For Home and Church: Old Testament 2026

Read alongside: Daniel 1-7

Start with the official lesson. Explore its invitations to trust God, pray, and think about faith when the outcome is not what you hoped for.

Bring a question: What do Daniel 1, 3, and 6 teach you about responding to pressure?

Access: Free full lesson.

https://www.churchofjesuschrist.org/study/manual/come-follow-me-for-home-and-church-old-testament-2026/46?lang=eng

Daniel 1

Biblical text / traditionally attributed to Daniel

Scripture / King James Version, published online by The Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-day Saints

Read alongside: Daniel 1

Return to the account of Daniel and his friends at the king's court. Look at what is chosen for them and how they respond.

Bring a question: How does Daniel combine a firm decision with a respectful request?

Access: Free full chapter.

https://www.churchofjesuschrist.org/study/scriptures/ot/dan/1?lang=eng

Daniel 3

Biblical text / traditionally attributed to Daniel

Scripture / King James Version, published online by The Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-day Saints

Read alongside: Daniel 3

Read the whole furnace account, including the friends' answer before they know whether they will be rescued.

Bring a question: What does "But if not" add to their statement of faith?

Access: Free full chapter.

https://www.churchofjesuschrist.org/study/scriptures/ot/dan/3?lang=eng

A. Scripture & Church teaching / continued

Daniel 6

Biblical text / traditionally attributed to Daniel

Scripture / King James Version, published online by The Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-day Saints

Read alongside: Daniel 6

Follow Daniel's prayer, the officials' accusations, and the king's response. Notice what Daniel was already doing before the decree.

Bring a question: How does "as he did aforetime" change your understanding of his prayer?

Access: Free full chapter.

https://www.churchofjesuschrist.org/study/scriptures/ot/dan/6?lang=eng

Daniel

The Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-day Saints

Church study help / Bible Dictionary

Read alongside: Daniel 1-12

Use this short overview to orient yourself to the book's stories and visions. Read it alongside the text and the official lesson.

Bring a question: How do the stories in chapters 1-6 prepare you to read the visions?

Access: Free full entry.

A Church-published study aid; not a substitute for the scripture text.

https://www.churchofjesuschrist.org/study/scriptures/bd/daniel?lang=eng

Be Not Afraid, Only Believe

Dieter F. Uchtdorf

Apostolic teaching / October 2015 general conference, The Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-day Saints

Read alongside: Daniel 1; connections to Daniel 3 and 6

Consider President Uchtdorf's use of Daniel's example to discuss belief and courageous discipleship. The official Daniel lesson recommends this message.

Bring a question: What counsel helps you act faithfully without treating faith as a guarantee of an easy outcome?

Access: Free full message.

https://www.churchofjesuschrist.org/study/general-conference/2015/10/be-not-afraid-only-believe?lang=eng

Hebrews 11:32-40

Biblical text / author of Hebrews unnamed in the text

Scripture cross-reference / King James Version, published online by The Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-day Saints

Read alongside: Hebrews 11; Daniel 3 and 6

This passage remembers both deliverance and suffering among people of faith. Some examples recall the furnace and the lions.

Bring a question: Why might the same chapter honor people who were rescued and people who suffered?

Access: Free full chapter.

Content note: includes persecution and death; explore with a trusted adult if helpful.

https://www.churchofjesuschrist.org/study/scriptures/nt/heb/11?lang=eng

B. Videos & Supplemental Commentary

Independent commentary is supplemental, not official Church teaching. The video itself requires internet access; the questions below can begin a discussion on paper.

Daniel: Choosing God's Kingdom Over Ours

Lynne Hilton Wilson

Supplemental video / Scripture Central / Handmaidens, Harems, Heroines / 27:58

Read alongside: Daniel 1, 2, 5, 6 and 11

Wilson explores faith in Daniel's court stories, God's kingdom, and women in and around the narratives. Compare her interpretations with the scripture itself. Includes discussion of ancient violence, eunuchs, and punishment of families.

Bring a question: Which idea is stated in Daniel, and which is the presenter's interpretation or historical reconstruction?

Access: Free video page and full auto-generated transcript verified; playback may vary by location.

Independent religious commentary, not official Church teaching. Introduction checked against the full YouTube auto-generated transcript and the publisher's episode description. Captions may contain errors. Her discussion of Daniel's mother is an imaginative reflection, not information given in Daniel 1.

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4nI5UzicHWw

Choose a trail through the library

Life in ancient Babylon: Daniel 1; Holm; Beaulieu.

Faith under pressure: Daniel 1, 3, 6; Be Not Afraid, Only Believe.

The fiery furnace: Daniel 3; Prinsloo; Beaulieu.

Daniel and the lions' den: Daniel 6; Hebrews 11; Wilson.

Literary connections: Valeta; Prinsloo; Tanner.

Historical questions: Holm; Beaulieu; Patterson; Tanner.

A question I want to investigate

What does the scripture say? What would I need to learn from another source? Sharing your writing is optional.

Visit the online library

Scan when you have a device, or type the address below. No reading activity or personal notes are collected by this study site.

https://spelibertatis.github.io/come-follow-me-study/explore.html

C. Historical & Academic Scholarship

Scholars may disagree about Daniel's setting, authorship, composition, and interpretation. Read their reasons carefully; disputed proposals are not settled facts.

The Book of Daniel in Recent Research (Part 1)

David M. Valeta

Research survey / Currents in Biblical Research 6(3), 2008 / SAGE

Read alongside: Daniel 1-6

Discover the kinds of questions scholars ask about Daniel's court stories: their literary form, language, and life under empires. This is a map of research, not one final answer.

Bring a question: What might you notice in Daniel 1 or 6 if you read it as a story about living in another people's empire?

Access: Free abstract; full article restricted.

Introduction based on the publisher's abstract. Technical vocabulary; try the abstract first.

https://doi.org/10.1177/1476993X07084791

Daniel 3: Intratextual Perspectives and Intertextual Tradition

G. T. M. Prinsloo

Journal article / Acta Patristica et Byzantina 16(1), 2005 / Taylor & Francis

Read alongside: Daniel 3; connections across biblical literature

Look for patterns inside Daniel 3 and links to other texts. Prinsloo reads the account as a court tale and considers its later importance to communities facing persecution.

Bring a question: How do repeated commands and the friends' repeated loyalty shape your reading of Daniel 3?

Access: Abstract verified; full-text access requires verification.

"Intratextual" means within a text; "intertextual" means between texts. Introduction based on the abstract, not a full-text review.

https://doi.org/10.1080/10226486.2005.11745749

Book of Daniel

Tawny Holm

Reference article / Oxford Research Encyclopedia of Religion, 2019 / Oxford University Press

Read alongside: Daniel 1-12

Explore how the court stories and visions fit together. Holm presents the scholarly view that the book reached its final form centuries after the events of its setting.

Bring a question: What is the difference between when a story is set and when a text takes its final form?

Access: Free abstract; full article restricted.

Holm proposes finalization in the Maccabean period, perhaps by 164 BCE. This influential scholarly position is not presented here as an undisputed fact or Church doctrine. Introduction based on the abstract.

https://doi.org/10.1093/acrefore/9780199340378.013.152

C. Historical & Academic Scholarship / continued

The Babylonian Background of the Motif of the Fiery Furnace in Daniel 3

Paul-Alain Beaulieu

Journal article / Journal of Biblical Literature 128(2), 2009 / Society of Biblical Literature; DOI links to publisher

Read alongside: Daniel 3

Investigate ancient texts about punishment by fire and the background they may offer for the furnace story. A historical parallel can illuminate a setting without proving every event in a narrative.

Bring a question: What could an ancient text establish about a practice - and what could it not establish about the three friends?

Access: Citation and article excerpt verified; full-text access through this link requires verification.

Technical research on ancient punishments. Beaulieu treats reconstruction of the story's transmission as uncertain; do not turn a proposed background into proof of the miracle.

https://doi.org/10.2307/25610183

Holding On To Daniel's Court Tales

Richard D. Patterson

Journal article / Journal of the Evangelical Theological Society 36(4), 1993 / Evangelical Theological Society; hosted by Galaxie

Read alongside: Daniel 1-6

Compare an evangelical discussion of Daniel's court tales with the other research here. The opening reviews debates about dating and the relationship between the stories and visions.

Bring a question: Which reasons does an author give for a position, and which assumptions need a closer look?

Access: Free opening excerpt; full article requires subscription and login.

Introduction is limited to the accessible opening. Do not treat the preview as a full review of the author's argument.

https://www.galaxie.com/article/jets36-4-02

The Literary Structure of the Book of Daniel

J. Paul Tanner

Journal article / Bibliotheca Sacra 160, 2003 / Dallas Theological Seminary; PDF hosted by the author

Read alongside: Daniel 1-12, especially 2-7

Trace how stories and visions might be arranged as a whole. Tanner argues for literary unity and discusses patterns linking chapters, from a conservative evangelical perspective.

Bring a question: Compare Daniel 3 and 6: what do their threats, faithful responses, and rescues have in common?

Access: Free full PDF / opens outside this site.

A proposed literary arrangement helps you compare passages; it does not by itself settle authorship or dating.

https://paultanner.org/English%20HTML/Publ%20Articles/Lit%20Struc%20of%20Dan%20-%20P%20Tanner.pdf

Advanced Research / optional

You can ask careful questions without rushing to an answer. These optional notes help you compare the sources above.

Five kinds of claims to keep separate

What scripture says

Daniel 3 narrates the friends' refusal and rescue. Point to verses before adding an explanation.

What surviving evidence establishes

An ancient document establishes that its words survive. Ask whether it reports an event, tells a literary story, or imagines a punishment; those are different kinds of evidence.

What scholars propose

Holm describes a later final form for Daniel; Tanner argues for unity from a conservative evangelical perspective. Evaluate their reasons without making either position stand for every scholar.

What Church teachings affirm

The official lesson teaches trust in the Lord amid trials. Read its linked apostolic teachings as gospel instruction, not as a substitute for evaluating a historical argument.

What remains uncertain

The precise stages of composition, the relationship between some stories and surviving records, and the historical identity of Darius the Mede remain debated. "We do not know" can be an honest conclusion.

Compare arguments, not just conclusions

Start with Valeta's research map and Holm's overview. Then compare Tanner's literary approach and Patterson's available opening. For each, ask: What evidence is cited? What does the author infer? What would challenge the proposal?

Many historical-critical scholars date the book's final form to the second century BCE; conservative evangelical scholars often defend an earlier origin and Danielic authorship. These broad descriptions do not erase differences within either group. Literary unity and historical dating are related questions, but one does not automatically prove the other.

Investigate the furnace without overclaiming

Use Prinsloo for connections within and between texts and Beaulieu for ancient cultural parallels. A parallel may help explain a motif - a recurring idea or image. It does not independently verify the three friends' rescue.

When an article is restricted, limit your claims to what you can actually read. A title or abstract cannot stand in for the whole argument.

Source checks: November 8, 2026. Access can change; "requires verification" means full access or playback could not be confirmed. Research supports context and inquiry; it does not replace scripture or authoritative Church teaching.

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